

STAGE THIRTEEN • TEAMWORK & COLLABORATION

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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Stage Thirteen • Teamwork & Collaboration

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Thirteen, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I don't currently have a real team project to work with?

A: That's fine — the facilitator will form a temporary working team at the start of Session 1 specifically so every exercise across the stage has something real to attach to.

Q2. Do I have to share details of a real, active team conflict with the group?

A: No. Several exercises ask you to reflect on or plan around a real conflict, but you're never required to disclose specifics to the group. If something's genuinely unresolved and current, bring it to your facilitator privately rather than processing it live in the session.

Q3. What's the actual difference between consensus and compromise?

A: Consensus means the whole team genuinely agrees, with every concern actually addressed, not just outvoted. Compromise means both sides get some but not all of what they wanted, and both can genuinely support the outcome even though it's not their first choice. Neither is a fallback for the other — different situations call for different ones.

Q4. What if my team genuinely can't reach consensus on something?

A: That's normal and expected for some decisions. FIRST Q24 (Team Compromise) is specifically about finding a genuine, workable middle ground for exactly those situations, rather than forcing a false consensus or letting the team stay stuck.

Q5. How honest should a retrospective actually be?

A: Genuinely honest — that's the entire point of FIRST Q27. A retrospective that only covers what went well misses the real, actionable learning that comes from examining what didn't. It doesn't need to assign blame, but it does need to name real gaps.

Q6. What if I'm not in a position to mediate a team conflict because I'm not the leader?

A: FIRST Q21 is specifically built around this — conflict resolution isn't only a designated leader's job. Any team member genuinely capable of helping, regardless of title, contributes real value.